

EDUCATION	Columbia University2024 – Present M.A. in Media Studies & Sociology Research Advisors: Diane Vaughan, James Chu GPA 4.10/4.00 Thesis: <i>Social Vulnerabilities of Large Language Models</i> Brigham Young University–Hawaii2022 – 2024 B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science Research Advisor: Mason Allred GPA 3.81/4.00
AREAS OF INTEREST	Social Impacts of AI; Social Media; Well-Being; Trust & Deception; Human-AI Collaboration
BOOK	[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati. Emilio Barkett <i>Barnes and Noble Press</i>, 2022.
PUBLICATIONS	[1] Reasoning Isn’t Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs. Emilio Barkett, Olivia Long, Madhavendra Thakur <i>NeurIPS</i>, 2025. [<i>under review</i>].
WORKS IN PROGRESS	[3] Imagining the Future: Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development at OpenAI. Emilio Barkett <i>OSF Preprint</i>, 2025. [2] Evaluating AI Persuasion Across Socioeconomic Status. Emilio Barkett, Robin Hart <i>Working Paper</i>. [1] Collaborative Dynamics Between Humans and LLMs in Problem-Solving and Conversation. Emilio Barkett, Anna Thieser, Paul Kröger <i>Working Paper</i>.
RESEARCH EXPERIENCE	Columbia AI Alignment ClubNew York, NY Principal InvestigatorMarch 2025 – Present Research Advisors: Yau-Meng Wong, Paul Kröger - Formed research agenda; created experimental design; led writing; technical implementation of Python/API calls; mentored four undergraduate collaborators; managed publication timeline. Columbia UniversityNew York, NY Research AssistantJan 2025 – Present Research Advisor: James Chu - Regression analysis in R; data cleaning; synthesized literature review; prepared survey data; contributed to manuscript structure; asymmetrical collaboration. Columbia UniversityNew York, NY Independent Graduate ResearcherAug 2024 – Present Research Advisors: Diane Vaughan, Gil Eyal, James Chu - Formed research agendas for several projects; developed semi-structured interviews; regression analysis in R; API calls for evaluating LLMs in Python. Brigham Young University–HawaiiOahu, HI UX Research AssociateJune 2023 – June 2024 Research Advisors: Curtis Lefrandt, Scott Stiles - Ethnographic fieldwork to identify user pain points; synthesized insights into journey maps; presented policy recommendations to the University President’s Council.

Brigham Young University–Hawaii
Data Scientist

Oahu, HI
April 2022 – June 2023

- University surveys through Qualtrics; analyzed data in R; presented to executive leadership.

**AWARDS &
FELLOWSHIPS**

AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club. Jan 2025 – Present
Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$1,500. 2022
Dean’s List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, \$500. 2022

PRESENTATIONS

Conferences

- NeurIPS 2025, San Diego, CA, December 2025. *Reasoning Isn’t Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs* [Submitted]
- Trust and Safety Research Conference 2025, Stanford University, September 2025. *Evaluating AI Persuasion Across Socioeconomic Status* [Submitted]
- Beyond Our Screens: Reimagining Critical Media Literacy Symposium, University of Notre Dame, August 2025. *Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development*
- ICML 2025 Workshop, Vancouver, Canada, July 2025. *Reasoning Isn’t Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs* [Submitted]
- Cultural Studies Association 2025 Conference, California Institute of the Arts, May 2025. *Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development*
- Data Science Day, Columbia University, April 2025. *Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development*
- AI Summit, Columbia University, March 2025. *Sociotechnical Imaginaries in AGI Development*
- Artifacts of Control, Lincoln Center for the Performing Arts, Dec 2024. *Surveillance on University Campuses*
- Undergraduate Research Conference, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, Dec 2024. *Media and War: A Genealogy of the Alternate Narrative*

**ACADEMIC
GROUPS**

Media in the Digital Age Interest Group, Allan Turing Institute. Oct 2024 – Present
Science, Knowledge, and Technology Workshop, Columbia University. Aug 2024 – Present

**RESEARCH
METHODS**

Quantitative Research:

Survey design, regression analysis, text analysis, web prototyping, computational social science, machine learning, natural language processing

Qualitative Research:

Ethnographic field research, interviews, focus groups, content analysis, speculative methods, think-aloud protocol, usability testing

**COMPUTER &
CODE**

Python, R, SPSS, VS Code, Qualtrics, L^AT_EX

LANGUAGES

English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)